

August 3, 2000

Mr. [REDACTED]
[REDACTED]

[REDACTED] ki,

I served on the "USS FDR CVA-42 from 1962-65 as a radar operator. I detected a very large UFO during my mid-watch on radar off the coast of Sardinia in late 63. I came across the posting on the Canadian UFO web site.

I provided the Senate Intelligence Committee with an affidavit detailing my experience. During this particular cruise there were several photographers on board to document the NATO fleet operations. They were present on board the night of my contact on radar. I was told in no uncertain terms to keep my mouth shut for 20 years.

To the point of all this, do you have any copies of photo's the photographer [REDACTED] took or know where to get in touch with him ?

I'm assisting [REDACTED] and other team members investigating the MJ12 documents wherein the Roosevelt is mentioned as having numerous UFO reports during the late 50's thru 60's. Your input is valued and I would compensate you for any photo copies you might have. I cannot seem to locate any web info. on [REDACTED]

[REDACTED]

[REDACTED]

David [Spencer] was one of my students and he said "I'm a Physics teacher. Would you like me to take over this course?", and I said, "Yes, I would." But the point is, if you don't know how to do an investigation, the Manual doesn't teach you. How do you interview a witness? How do you do triangulations? How do you get soil samples? All of the many components that are required to fill out those forms are not taught in the Manual. You can look some things up and figure it out but it's not designed as a course. This Guide is designed as a course. You can either make it a self-study course and take the test afterwards, or you can use it in a classroom situation with a teacher. David also sells a teacher's syllabus with visual aids and things like that. So I felt like what we were doing was filling that need. I know Michigan has filled that need with the tape "How to Interview the UFO Witness." That has figured heavily in what David has done. Also, Larry Childs [Washington State Director] had a "How to Interview a UFO Witness." Those resource materials were used to compile this manual, plus David's experience as a Physics teacher.

Ellen, thanks again for your time and this interview!

To procure a copy of the *Austin UFO Field Investigator's Training Guide*, contact us at (517) 394-7320 or by mail at 3639 Stoneleigh, and we'll get you current price and ordering information.

Interview: Chester Grusinski

Chester Grusinski is a Michigan MUFON member who has achieved national recognition for his work at uncovering UFO sightings made from the Franklin D. Roosevelt CVA-42, once the Navy's premier aircraft carrier. Chet served on that aircraft carrier from 1958 to 1960; his and others' sighting of a UFO from the deck of the F.D.R. in the summer of 1958 led to the research detailed below. Chet has been profiled on "Sightings," and his

efforts have been reported in UFO Magazine and the Ohio Casebook, an excellent quarterly publication put out by Ohio MUFON State Director Bill Jones and the MidOhio Research Associates group. Chet contributes newspaper clippings to us regularly, and graciously agreed to this interview for the Michigan MUFON Newsletter.

Mr. Grusinski, thank you for consenting to do this interview.

Would you tell us about the UFO experience you had on the USS Franklin D. Roosevelt (CVA-42)?

I had just reported for duty on the USS Franklin D. Roosevelt on July 24th of 1958; we had just left the New York Navy yard a short time after that. Around September or October we were on a shake down cruise near Gitmo [ed. note: Guantanamo Bay and Naval Base] Cuba, it was dark outside, and I was down below decks at the time. There was a bunch of men who came running up from the engine room, and a couple of minutes later another bunch came running up and I followed them. They went all the way up to the flight deck. They were watching a small light that was following our ship. Then the light approached our ship. It came in close enough that I could see a row of windows and the figures watching us from inside. The bridge watch was screaming on the ship's intercom for the officer of the deck or bridge to get up on the double. The impression that I got was that those figures that were watching us were not human beings. The figures walked away from the windows and the object turned a red-orange color and took off very fast until it was out of sight. The Navy kept quiet about this incident. Later we had special investigators who came aboard ship. I had heard that they had come to investigate gambling below decks. I found out later they were CIA..

What made you decide to explore the matter of other sightings from the FDR, besides the sighting you had?

A few years after I was out of the Navy I used to read about UFO sightings in the library. I even went to the library in downtown Detroit. Around 1977-78, I read

in a newspaper clipping that a citizens group (CAUSE) in a New York law firm were going after the CIA and our government in a court battle to release top secret UFO Information. They were going to go back as far as 1947. So, I sent them a letter about the sighting I witnessed on the USS F.D.R. CVA-42. They tried to help me to get some information but they could not do it. Then some other researchers came up with the 1952 UFO sighting (Operation Main Brace) and three photographs of a flying disk were taken from the aircraft carrier "Franklin D. Roosevelt." And, the object overtook the NATO fleet. Other researchers were trying to help me to find other witnesses that were on the flight deck with me and witnessed the 1958 sighting. By doing this I started to find out about the other UFO sightings on the same ship.

How did you go about contacting potential witnesses?

I ran ads in the *NAVAL AFFAIRS* as well as other military magazines. Then around 1988, I read in a *DAV Magazine* about the USS F.D.R. CVA-42 Reunion. I found a couple more witnesses and also more information.

How many different sightings have you been able to link with the F.D.R.?

About ¹⁰ six UFO sightings on the same ship.

Besides your sighting in the fall of 1958, there was a dramatic one which took place off Rio de Janeiro, Brazil, on July 26 of 1956. You have at least two witnesses independently confirming the basic facts about that sighting. What did they see?

On July 26th of 1956, two disk objects were suspended in mid-air. They were over one another; they had two rows of counter-rotating lights. The upper disk released a fire ball object, that dropped into the top of the lower one. Within seconds they both vanished with tremendous speed. The objects could have been between 75 and 100 feet in length. And, these were seen by Leon Treadwell, Petty Officer Third Class, O.I. Division. All involved witnesses were told to keep a tight lip on what they saw. And, Treadwell had to sign papers that he

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would tell no one for twenty years. Another one for the same time period, the 25th or the 27th of July 1956: a cigar object was seen and tracked on radar. And the CIC radars said it went off the scope in two or three sweeps. That was witnessed by a chief warrant officer. His name was John C. Hau. Mr. Hau went after the deck logs for his sighting in 1983, and he found nothing. I found John C. Hau by running an ad in the *Naval Institute Proceedings*, January 1992.

In the *UFO Magazine* (Vol. 9, #6, 1994) article on your efforts, there was some interesting speculation on why so many sightings have involved the F.D.R. Could you give us your thoughts on this matter?

The F.D.R. was the first U.S. carrier at the time that had thermonuclear capability — the first and only carrier at the time allowed to transport the H-Bomb. This is one of the theories.

Here are several questions about the matter of ship's records. The F.D.R. was decommissioned in 1977, and its ship's logs were searched for UFO references, with apparently negative results. Are you satisfied that the search of the logs was done thoroughly? Do you think the log entries were never made, or if made, were "purged" soon after? If they were removed, isn't there some regulation against such tampering? And who would have the authority to break such regulations?

The F.D.R. was decommissioned in the year 1977. Myself and other UFO researchers have searched the logs; we also used the Freedom of Information Act, going as far back as 1980. We had the help of the New York law firm. We tried the Navy Department and NSA and also CIA, trying to find some reference to any of the sightings.

I had also got a copy of the ship's deck logs from the years 1958-9; a lot of information was blackened out. After looking it over, later I tossed it out. Researcher Barry Greenwood said in a letter I suppose it is possible that log listings were not made of UFO sightings, that somehow there was a stigma attached to doing so. Regulations would have required this under JANAP-146, which is a Joint Chiefs of Staff

directive which is for official use only. The subject of the directive is: Canadian-United States Communications instruction for reporting vital intelligence sightings. If anything was on ship's deck logs it could have been taken out; anything else related to the UFO sightings could have been blackened out!!

You and your research were profiled on the "Sightings" television series. Could you give our readers an idea about how that came to be?

The "Sightings" TV people called me on the phone, after *UFO Magazine* did the USS F.D.R. UFO sightings story.

What was it like to work with such a television program?

The "Sightings" TV people came out and interviewed me at the Sterling Inn in Sterling Heights, Michigan. It was interesting, and I showed them my research papers and documents. They interviewed also a Gunnery Officer who lives in Washington, Michigan. I found him through the USS F.D.R. Reunion New Members name list. He saw one of the 1952 UFO sightings and he sent me newspaper clippings about the F.D.R. and UFO sightings in "Operation Main Brace". The "Sightings" people also went out of state to interview the other witnesses I found through my research.

Overall, how well do you think the "Sightings" people treated your story?

I think the "Sightings" people did a good job of putting it all together. They left out a few things that I said to them. They used a few Naval film clips, which was good. I'm quite satisfied with the way the entire story was put together.

Based upon your experience as a researcher, what personal qualities make for a good UFO investigator?

Well, I do not know what would make a good UFO investigator. But, I have spent a good number of years working on name lists and researching history on the aircraft carrier. And, I have sent a lot of inquiries out looking for information.

At this point, do you have a sense on where your research on the F.D.R. sightings is leading you?

Through the many years I have contacted a number of interesting people, who have helped me with documents and newspaper clippings about the F.D.R. UFO sightings. My wife Carol Ann had a feeling that I was beating my poor head against a wall, trying to get information on these UFO sightings. This is not an easy task. Carol Ann has become a helper to me; I wonder to myself could it be the wife has softened up to my efforts? I was surprised to be asked to appear on the "Sightings" TV program. I have heard of so many peoples' interest in wanting to appear on the TV programs, I'm hoping to find other witnesses that were with me on that flight deck with me.

Have your investigations led to any repercussions from the Navy that you can talk about?

When I was looking for information on the 1958 sighting a Commander that was on the F.D.R. the same time period that I was, told me that I was not supposed to even mention something like this.

What other aspects of ufology most interest you?

UFOs and the Military interest me.

How may Michigan MUFON and its readers assist your research efforts?

I would like to contact anyone who knows about the UFO sightings seen by ship's crew members, tracked on radar or any sightings while the ship was commissioned. If any of you readers know of anyone who was on this ship and who may know of anything of the UFO sightings, they could contact me. Or if any one would be interested in printing a story.

Thanks very much for this interview, Chet! Chester Grusinski may be contacted at 19780 Vermader Street, Clinton Township, Michigan, 48035.

BY
JACQUES
VALLEE 1965

listed here. Rather than imposing on the reader descriptions of the standard cases, such as the Washington incidents (which can be found in most books on the problem), I will try to select a few lesser-known cases that might also prove of interest.

As early as January, at Gallup, New Mexico, several objects that moved swiftly and occasionally remained in front of the disk of the sun had been seen. On January 30, in Korea, a huge disk that revolved like a large horizontal wheel was observed for several minutes. It radiated an orange light from its whole surface and gave off bluish flames from the edge. On May 10, 1952, at 6:00 P.M., twelve persons in La Roche-sur-Yon saw a flat disk fully lighted; it flew without noise and took off vertically to overtake another UFO seen higher in the sky (100, 101). On May 20, 1952, an aerial object was reported at Denham, England, "giving rise to small disks that scattered in all directions."

On June 12, a celebrated sighting was made at Le Bourget Airport in Paris (102). A large number of witnesses saw the "light," including the control-tower operators, pilots in landing aircraft and persons living on the north side of the city.

During the month of July—which marked the maximum of the wave—activity was equally divided between France, North Africa and the United States. On July 6, for instance, two bluish "disks" were seen at Thann in Alsace; a luminous sphere was reported at Bone, Algeria; and another disk was seen at Bou-Hadjar, near Oran, during the night of July 7.

Maximum intensity was reached in the last two weeks of July, and then the wave decreased and fell to a minimum in the second week of September. But even then it did not die completely; a new burst of sightings appeared in European countries. The peak of the wave had been marked by two sensational observations made in Washington above the Capitol and the White House, a restricted-flight area permanently controlled by radar.* The second lobe of the intensity distribution, which took place in the fall, corresponds to another series of sensational sightings, those made during maneuvers of the navy of the North Atlantic Treaty Organization (Operation Mainbrace).

in the department of Yonne, on September 19. This sighting was described in a scientific journal under the title "suspicious object" (103):

M. R. Sommer, pilot and aircraft manufacturer, coming back from Beine to Chablis, Yonne, on September 19, writes: "I was driving back in the night, which was dark, without moon or stars. We came out of the village of Beine and drove about five minutes, when we were greatly surprised to realize that a bright, unknown object had appeared in the sky on the left side of the road. It had the shape of an olive and a golden color. Its major axis was vertical. The sighting was indeed fairylike. The phenomenon lasted for five minutes. The minor axis of the object was a little smaller than the apparent diameter of the moon. A few minutes later, I visited the neighboring villages and examined the churches, fearing the apparition might have been caused by illuminations or reflections; but everywhere I found the same absolute calm, and no important light was to be seen. The road was deserted."

1952

The next day, three photographs of a flying disk were taken from the aircraft carrier "Franklin Roosevelt" during Operation Mainbrace in the English Channel. The object was flying extremely fast behind the NATO fleet, and the witnesses, obviously, were numerous and competent in identification of flying objects. The same day a number of sightings were made elsewhere in Europe; and the most important military airbase in Denmark saw a flying disk, apparently metallic, at 7:30 P.M. It disappeared in the east.

On September 21, six jet fighters chased a bright spherical object for two minutes. One of the aircraft returning to its base spotted the UFO again and tried without success to reach it. The same day, Morocco was flooded with reports of disks from Tangier to Marrakesh and Casablanca. In the latter case, five thousand persons attending a boxing match saw the object. On September 22, the night shift of a factory in Bayonne, France, watched for twenty minutes the classical "swinging motion" of a UFO. Later that day, an aircraft landing at Titmellil-Casablanca Airfield was passed at a low altitude by a bright object.

'Witness' claims UFO cover-up

A witness to a 1968 UFO sighting wants us to know the following:

It happened while he was on board the U.S. Navy aircraft carrier the USS Franklin D. Roosevelt. The FDR was the first U.S. carrier at the time to have thermonuclear capability. The only carrier then allowed to transport the H-bomb.

This sighting was tracked on their radar through three sweeps. It was never entered on the ship's log.

Chester Grusinski served on the FDR from 1958 to 1960. The ship was decommissioned in October 1977 and sold for scrap in March '78. His story:

"I reported for duty July 24. September we were on a shake-down cruise off Guantanamo Bay one dark night. I was below decks at the time. Our crew discovered a small light following our ship. The men came running up from the engine room all excited. I followed them.

"This light then came at us. Suddenly it turned red-orange color and we were able to see it was a cigar-shaped object. Inside it, a row of figures watching us.

"The impression I got was that those figures were not human beings. They walked away from the window and the object took off very fast until it was lost from sight.

Cindy Adams



"The bridge watch screamed on the intercom for the officer of the deck to get up there on the double. At the same time, for some unknown reason, all the ship's maneuvers stopped dead.

"Special investigators subsequently came aboard to investigate. We learned later they'd been CIA."

Grusinski, who is in possession of photos, letters and documents,

then cites further outer-space visitors to this one super-special ship:

● During 1952's Operation Mainbrace, photos were taken by a journalist from the deck as a UFO overtook the NATO fleet.

● In '53, in the Mediterranean,

a commander had a visual sighting at the same moment radar was tracking it.

● In 1956, on July 26, while at anchor in Rio de Janeiro, one witness "drew a sketch of two disk objects, about 100 feet in length, suspended in mid-air, over one another. Two rows of counter-rotating lights. The upper disk released a fireball object onto the lower one. Within seconds they vanished with tremendous speed. This was seen by many. The sketch was sent to the Defense Department. Witnesses were told to tell no one for 20 years."

● In 1973 there was an additional sighting. Sworn testimonies exist in proof.

Grusinski, who may be reached in Clinton Township, Michigan, and cites the Freedom of Information Act, asks me, "Why has there remained a conspiracy to withhold this information from the public?"

I don't know, I have no answer, I'm trying to help. To tell you the truth, the only unidentified flying object I ever encountered was what some dyspeptic pigeon dropped on my terrace.

THIS being my extra-terrestrial column, I hereby report on Palm Beach's vintage terrestrial Brownie McLean. Her Global Future Theater Foundation is researching life on Mars, and Miss McLean has kindly offered me a job as that planet's first gossip columnist.

Only on Mars, kids, only on Mars.



E.T.

Kin scouting vacation sites?

ROBERT URICH signed with the American Program Bureau, the country's largest lecture agency. He'll go nationwide to talk about coping with cancer... Gary Smith, who produced Clinton's '92 inauguration, is doing ditto for Jan. 19... The sophisticated, sexy "Chicago" opening-night party was at Mirage. There a sign over the ladies' john said: "All women will be strip searched."

[REDACTED]
[REDACTED]
[REDACTED] [REDACTED]
[REDACTED] [REDACTED]

Dear Ms [REDACTED] an

Newspaper articles are enclosed about my UFO experience on the ship. [REDACTED] is also mentioned in some of the newspaper articles. Also, I am enclosing a letter from Harry Jordan. He was a radar operator on the USS F.D.R. from 1962-1965. He tracked a large UFO during NATO fleet operations. And, he was told in no uncertain terms to keep his mouth shut for twenty years.

I would like to see open congressional hearings on this UFO Cover-Up.

[REDACTED]

Clinton man says government covering up UFO sightings

By Samar Abulhassan

Macomb Daily Special Writer

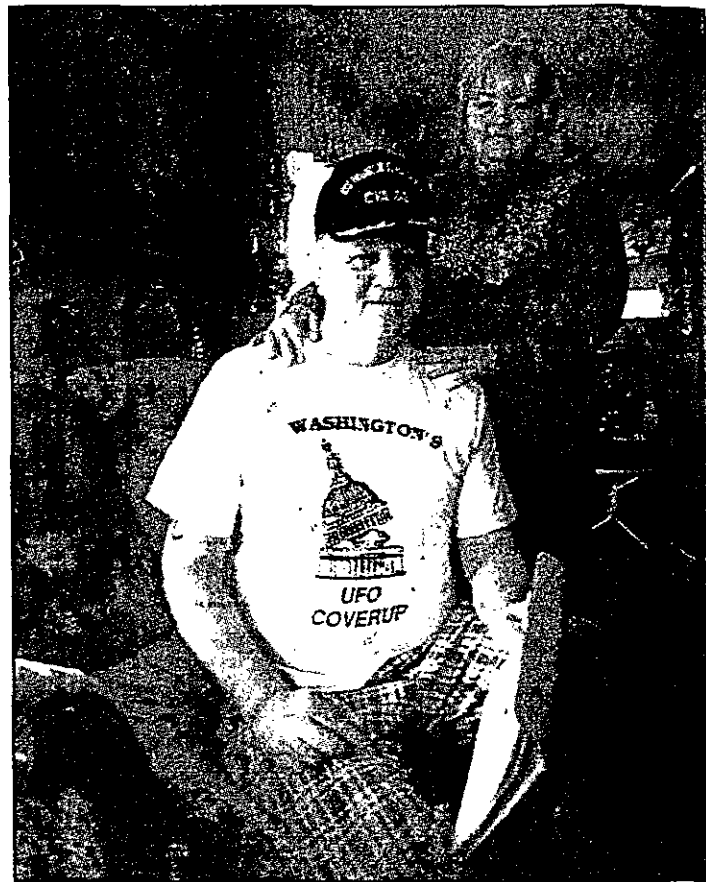
You don't have to be a believer to appreciate [redacted] story.

The Clinton Township man's testimony of spotting a UFO almost 30 years ago has been met with skepticism by many, but that hasn't stopped him from pursuing the truth about UFOs. The truth, he believes, that the government continues to withhold.

It was 1958, and [redacted] then 18, was aboard the Franklin D. Roosevelt aircraft carrier cruising the Caribbean near Cuba, when he was called up to the flight deck by fellow crew members.

It was there that he first made contact with the "little light following the ship."

As the light came closer, [redacted] said, it appeared to be a "cigar-shaped" figure, about 75 to 100 feet long. He said the UFO floated midair for several minutes and he could feel the heat on his face.



Macomb Daily staff photo by David Dalton

[redacted] here with his wife, Carol Ann, believes that he saw a UFO while aboard the Franklin D. Roosevelt in 1958.

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UFO

Continued from Page 1A

"There were silhouettes of figures looking at us," he said. "They had no features and you can tell they weren't human."

Grusinski said the bottom then turned a "bright, cherry red" and took off.

After the incident, Grusinski said, no one would admit anything happened. He said the CIA came aboard shortly after, but he was told they were investigating a gambling problem.

Since then, Grusinski has become consumed by UFO phenomena, collecting photos, letters and documents from witnesses who came in contact with UFOs from the same ship at various times.

He has photos of a 1952 UFO sighting, during "Operation Main-

brace," taken from the deck of the F.D.R. as the object "overtook the NATO fleet." He also names a 1953 incident reported by a Navy commander in the Mediterranean, which was also tracked by the radar.

Grusinski said there were two sightings in 1956, while the ship was at anchor in the port of Rio de Janeiro, Brazil. He said a witness drew a sketch of the objects and sent it to the Defense Department, but was told to tell no one for 20 years.

So why have UFOs been drawn to this one ship?

At that time, the F.D.R. was the first U.S. carrier that had thermonuclear capability and was the only one allowed to transport the hydrogen bomb, Grusinski said.

Through his research, Grusinski obtained a list of everyone on board during the 1958 "sighting" and has

written letters to all of them. But he still hasn't found any witnesses.

Requests under the Freedom of Information Act to the Navy, CIA and the National Security Agency have yielded no information.

But this has hardly discouraged Grusinski. He was featured on "Sightings," a television program out of Sterling Heights, in 1995 with other UFO witnesses, and has written a screenplay about his experience.

Grusinski said he is willing to "meet the government half-way."

He would settle for open congressional hearings, anything that would shed light on the matter.

"We're getting to a point now where there's a lot more awareness of UFOs," he said. "I think they must release the information soon."